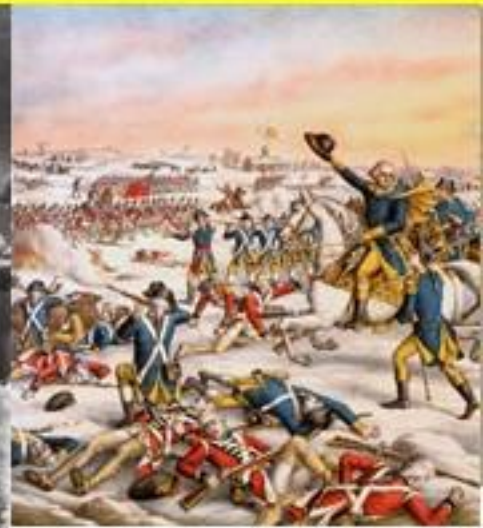


WORLD HISTORY

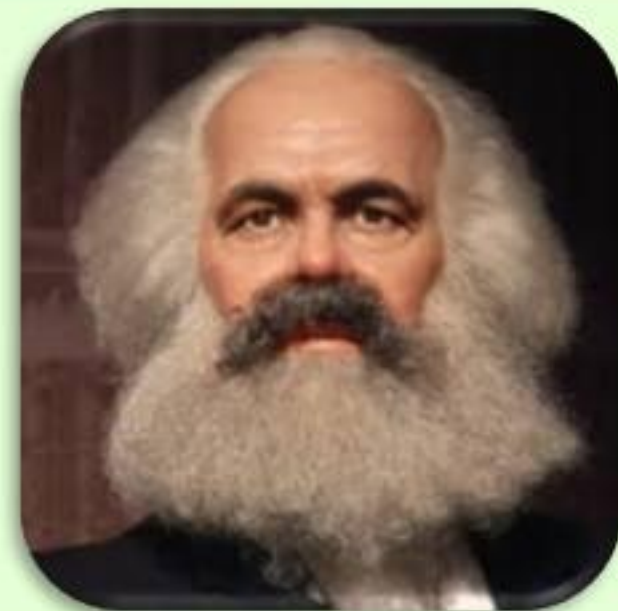


MODULE - 19

**THE SOCIALISM AND LABOR
MOVEMENTS IN EUROPE - 2**

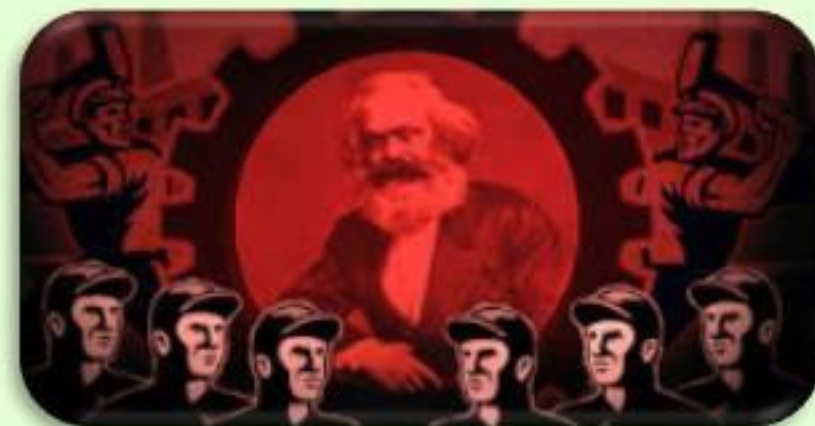
KARL MARX AND HIS PHILOSOPHY

- 1** Labour movement all over the world received great impetus with the arrival of Karl Marx and his Philosophy.
- 2** He made the workers realize that without their labour there can be no production.
- 3** He popularised the slogan that “the workers of the world unite; you have nothing to lose except your chains”.
- 4** In the development of his ideas he was very much influenced by the philosophy of Hegel. In fact Hegel's ideas became basic principles of Marxian philosophy.
- 5** He was also influenced by French socialists. The idea of the class struggle as propounded by the French socialists also became the mainstay of his philosophy.



KARL MARX AND HIS PHILOSOPHY

- 6 He viewed society in terms of economic relations, on which he developed his legal and political framework.
- 7 As economic relations change with mode of production. However, as these relations are based on surplus production and its appropriation, these relations produced two classes, one which produced the surplus and the other who appropriated it.
- 8 There was an inherent antagonism between these classes which led to class conflict.
- 9 This resulted in breaking up of old order and formation of a new one. Thus, Marxist perspective is centered on the economic aspects being the essential causes of social conflict.



KARL MARX AND HIS PHILOSOPHY

10 Capitalist class controls the state and the resources and hence is able to appropriate major part of surplus while the working class or the proletariat despite producing most of the surplus remains deprived.

11 This brings in inequalities between two classes, which results in class conflict.

12 The capitalist class always tries to capture maximum power and is bound to use it in its own favour. The power is thus bound to be misused.

13 According to him history of society is nothing else but that of a class struggle which is going on between economic and political classes.

14 Karl Marx is of the view that the modern capitalism system is sowing the seeds of its own destruction.



KARL MARX AND HIS PHILOSOPHY

15 According to him the capitalists, in order to have quick access to market places for selling their commodities, develop road and transport system, which are used by the workers for coming together.

16 Moreover, by trying to monopolise trade and industry small traders and industrialists are wiped out and they join the rank of workers.

17 Thus their rank goes on swallowing. The workers nowhere are provided facilities and they realise that their problems are the small all over.

18 Moreover, the employers keep them in a state of misery and that helps them in coming together and building a united camp against the employers.



MARXIST THEORY OF STATE

- 1 According to Marx the state expresses the will of the ruling classes only. Unlike Fabian Socialists who considered that emancipation of the workers was possible **within** the aegis of the state, Marx considered state to be coercive.
- 2 The state, according to Marx, has always sided with the rich and tries to maintain their hegemony.
- 3 It passes only such laws that perpetuate the interest of the capitalist class. He has also said that state protects private property, which is based on exploitation.

- 4 Marx thus envisaged a classless and stateless society.



CRITICISM OF THE MARXIAN PHILOSOPHY

- 1** Marxist philosophy takes into account only one **factor** into consideration i.e., **economic**. Entire Marxist philosophy revolves around the “economic factor”.
- 2** Of course the significance of economic factor cannot be undervalued but at the same time the philosophy has completely discounted social and religious factors.
- 3** Marx viewed the state to be coercive and an instrument for the oppressive for the poor. He lacked in imagination regarding the concept of welfare state.
- 4** He failed to realize that the state led interventions can play pivotal role in development and eradicating poverty.
- 5** Today everywhere in the world the need and necessity of the state is being realized.



CRITICISM OF THE MARXIAN PHILOSOPHY

- 6 State, today is performing not compulsory but also optional functions and more responsibilities are now being assigned to it.
- 7 Marx believed in only two identities for human kind i.e., capitalist class and working class.
- 8 He was of the view that members of these classes to be two different homogeneous groups.
- 9 He discounted other important identities like gender, caste, religion and nationality. Marx has glorified the idea of revolution and the role of violence in it.



CRITICISM OF THE MARXIAN PHILOSOPHY

- 10** He tried to establish that the problems of the workers are such that these will not be solved by peaceful methods.
- 11** But again that has not come true because in every state methods like arbitration, joint consultative machinery etc. have been evolved which bring the employers and employees together on the same forum and they amicably solve their problem.
- 12** Despite of all the drawbacks in his philosophy it cannot be denied that Marx brought a new life and vigour in the worker's movement.
- 13** He awaked them and today his philosophy is the basis of labour movement all over the world.



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